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Examiners' Report
Summer 2026

GCSE History 1HI0 P5

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Introduction

The Period Study focuses on a time span of at least 50 years and requires candidates to understand the unfolding narrative of substantial developments and issues associated with the period.

On the Period Studies papers all questions are assessed with a focus on particular second-order concepts (AO2): Question 01 on consequence, Question 02 on causation, consequence and change and Question 03 on consequence and significance. The first strand of the mark scheme shows AO2, with the candidate's increasing ability to make generalized comments to more analytical explanations and reasoning focused on the relevant second-order concept. The second strand of the mark scheme shows how AO1 is assessed with the candidate's ability to progress from responses with limited knowledge and understanding of the topic to deploying accurate and relevant information to show good knowledge and understanding of the period.

Centres are reminded that the indicative content in the mark scheme does not state what must be in responses but is meant to exemplify the range of material which examiners might expect to see in candidates' work. As the mark scheme guidance states any other relevant material must be credited.

As mentioned in previous Principal Examiner reports, there are responses that write in the first person, such as a diary or letter, for Question 02. Such responses should be avoided, as although AO1 can sometimes be rewarded, it is very unlikely that there will be any aspects of the work which can access AO2.

Question 1

Questions 01(a) and 01(b) focus on consequences, requiring candidates to explain valid consequences (AO2), this implies a link between the stated event and the consequential events or developments that are identified by the candidate. This explanation should be supported with specific information showing good knowledge and understanding (AO1). Candidates are expected to explain 'what happened as a result of the given event, development etc'. (2 x 4 marks).

In Question 01(a), candidates were asked to provide a valid consequence of Israel passing the Law of Return (1950). Most candidates showed an understanding of the Law of Return and could give a consequence, often being the increase of Jewish people to Israel. This question however was attempted much less often and generally done less well than the 1b question. Most candidates could provide a consequence of more Jews moving to Israel, a good response expanded into issues over a lack of housing or an increase in the size of the IDF. However, some focused on Palestinians returning, possibly confusing Law of Return with the Right to Return and were therefore sidetracked into giving details on this. Many referred to "Israelites" or "Israelis" as being given the right to return.

In Question 01(b), candidates were asked to provide a valid consequence of the Suez Crisis (1956). The standard was high on this question and was generally answered well, with most candidates able to give L2 answers with what felt like a majority gaining 4 marks. There were very few blank answers, if any, on this question. Candidates were able to reference specifics well in their explanations. One most common explanation in strong responses was that it led to Britain, France and Israel attacking Egypt (many could reference the Sevres agreement) in order to regain control of the Canal, often finishing with the idea that Nasser reacted by sinking ships in the Canal, making it unusable for trade -- the other most popular explanation was how this crisis led to humiliation of Britain and France due to the US condemnation of their actions. These often went on to explain how this was the end of British imperialism in the Middle East and the rise of the USA/USSR as most influential powers in the region. Many referenced Nasser's increased prestige in the Arab world as part of their explanation and explained how the crisis was beneficial to Egypt's economy, often referencing the 'Aswan Dam'. Weaker L1 answers often saw candidates give a very generalised explanation of world trade becoming difficult or price of goods worldwide increasing but were not able to link this to any specific knowledge such as 'Suez Canal' or 'Nasser of Egypt' or 'nationalisation' or 'Sevres Agreement'. There were also some candidates who confused this with the closure of the Canal as a result of the Six Day War.

Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–95

Answer ALL questions in this booklet.

1 (a) Explain **one** consequence of Israel passing the Law of Return (1950).

(4)

One consequence was the rise of Jewish population in Israel. The law meant that any Jew had the right to return to Israel. This also weakened ~~the~~ Israel's economy as there was a high demand of essentials due to continous arrival of Jews.

(b) Explain **one** consequence of the Suez Crisis (1956).

(4)

One consequence of the Suez crisis was it increased President Nasser of Egypt prestige. Despite Egypt lost, the Suez Crisis showed that Nasser was a powerful leader who could resist Israel and stand for western powers.

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Examiner Comments

1a) This candidate has identified "weakened Israel's economy" as a legitimate consequence with demand of essentials, making the AO2 a Level 2. This is supported with knowledge about the law regarding "any Jew had the right", making the AO1 Level 2. Hence the best fit would be the top of Level 2.
1b) This candidate has identified the consequence that the prestige of Nasser increased, and that he was a powerful leader, making the AO2 a Level 2. This is supported with specific knowledge such as naming Nasser and his position as President of Egypt, as well as the concept of resisting Israel, making the AO1 a Level 2. Hence the best fit for this would be the top of Level 2.

Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–95

Answer ALL questions in this booklet.

1 (a) Explain **one** consequence of Israel passing the Law of Return (1950).

(4)

A consequence of Israel passing the law of Return is that it enabled them to return to Palestine which they believed was promised to them.

(b) Explain **one** consequence of the Suez Crisis (1956).

(4)

One consequence of the Suez Crisis was that Nasser was able to ~~gain back the Suez~~ keep control of the Suez Canal which angered Arafat.

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Examiner Comments

1a) This candidate has made a simple comment with it "enabled them to return" making the AO2 a Level 1. The knowledge provided is generalised about the topic regarding Palestine and "promised to them", making the AO1 Level 1. Hence the best fit is top of Level 1.
1b) This candidate has provided a simple statement in the form of keeping "control of the Suez Canal" which makes the AO2 Level 1. The knowledge is limited with mention of Nasser making the AO1 Level 1. We ignore the Arafat comment as it does not add anything. Hence the best fit is the top of Level 1.

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Examiner Tip

Candidates should ensure they provide specific detail to support the consequence they have identified.

Question 2

Question 02 focuses on an analytical narrative and the AO2 concepts of causation, consequence and change. Candidates were asked to provide an analytical narrative of the key events of the Six Day War (1967). Most candidates could give some detail of the Six Day War, but often relied too heavily on the stimulus points. Some could provide detailed build up and consequences of the war, often including the dogfight or UN resolution 242. Some could also give day-by-day events of what happened during the war. The best answers went beyond giving a good but simply chronological account and actually said why one thing led to another. Many candidates mixed up events with other wars, often bringing in the ceasefires in the 1948 war, or the involvement on Britain and France from the Suez Crisis. A surprising number seemed to assume that the question was asking them about what caused the war, and so spent a lot of time on the build up to the war and comparatively little on the war itself. Many had learnt by rote the day-by-day events without really being able to explain how/why one event led to the other, a particular hazard with this question type. Fairly frequently candidates were mixing up the Six Day War with events from other wars.

2 Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Six Day War (1967).

(8)

You **may** use the following in your answer:

- closing of the Tiran Straits
- UN ceasefire

You **must** also use information of your own.

The Six day war mainly consists between egypt and Israel. Within war Israel always had the support and backing of the US which improved their military strength.

Egypt were tired of Israel always having one up on them within the fighting side of war, however egypt are a huge country and they also own quite a bit of land, one being the Straits of Tiran, by egypt deciding to shut this area of water it suffocates Israels ability to trade and all around growth as a new nation.

Before the war had even started, there were 700,000 palestinians trying to seek refuge from the neighbouring Arab States, egypt was sick of it, they

wanted all the Palestinians to go back to their homeland.

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Examiner Comments

This candidate has provided a narrative with some sequencing of events, although it lacks organisation at points, making it partial Level 2 for AO2. There is some knowledge in the form of backing of the US, but this is again partial Level 2 for AO1. Hence the best fit is the middle of Level 2.

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Examiner Tip

Candidates need to provide specific details to support their narrative.

2 Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Six Day War (1967).

(8)

You **may** use the following in your answer:

- closing of the Tiran Straits
- UN ceasefire

You **must** also use information of your own.

The lead up to the Six day was Was an intense period between ISrael and the Surrounding Arab States. A Major cause was the closure of the Straits of Tiran, which meant ISrael couldn't access supplies sent from abroad, a major problem for a small country surrounded by Arab states. The Cairo conference of 1966 also Set the middle East on edge as the PLO were formed, and rumours of ISrael diverting the River Jordan flew about. These rumours led to Nasser forming the Headwater diversion Scheme, close to the breakout of War. The final Straw however, was the tip-off from the USSR that ISrael was planning to attack.

In 1967, ISrael attacked Egypts airfields and Military bases, rendering Egypt useless in this Short outbreak of war. By taking Egypt out first, the IDF could then focus on Syria, which was also defeated on Day 1. Day 2 involved the take over of the Sinai and Golan Heights, the first of the occupied territories. Jerusalem then followed as the IDF pushed Jordan out of

the West bank, allowing across the the rest of the Sacred City. These events took up days 3 and 4. ISrael was becoming more confident in its ability to fight the Arab nations, but it was at this point that the UN intervened.

By day 6 of the fighting, the UN had ordered a cease fire between the Middle East Countries, which they all begrudingly agreed too. ISrael had gained large amounts of territory, come to known as the occupied territories that it would keep a hold onto for many years in the future. the UN had arranged for patrols along the border of the Sinai, protecting the Suez canal and various other parts of the middle East, like Gaza. Although their role was far from over.

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Examiner Comments

This candidate has a narrative which organises the material into a clear sequence, starting with the lead up to the war with the Cairo Conference, the role of the USSR, then the military actions and the role of the UN. There is linkage throughout the answer, such as "meant Israel couldn't access", "final straw", and "beaming with confidence" making the AO2 a Level 3. The supporting knowledge is good, with reference to the Headwater diversion, the IDF, areas occupied, making the AO1 a Level 3. Hence the best fit is the top of Level 3.

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Examiner Tip

Candidates need to ensure they establish a beginning, middle and end for the narrative, and utilise language which helps analyse the links between the events and not simply list the events one after the other.

Question 3

Question 03 focuses on significance by asking candidates to explain the importance of an event/person/development in relation to situations and/or unfolding developments. Here candidates are expected to explain 'what difference did the event/person/development make' to the identified situation and/or unfolding development. Candidates answer two questions from a choice of three. (2 x 8 marks)

This question is comprised of two 8 mark questions based on the second-order concepts of significance and consequence. Candidates had to explain the importance of two of the following three topics: the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49) for the state of Israel; Henry Kissinger for diplomatic relations between Israel and Egypt; the First Palestinian Intifada (1987–93) for the Palestinian issue. The three options were roughly equally attempted by candidates. Those who addressed the importance of the factor raised in relation to the development produced Level 3 responses when supported by good knowledge and understanding. This was in contrast to candidates who explained the importance of the factor in general terms, which normally stayed in Level 2. The majority of answers were able to focus on the question asked although a large number of candidates are still failing to link their answer to the second part of the question, that is for the state of Israel, diplomatic relations between Isael and Egypt, and the Palestinian issue.

In terms of the question on the Arab-Israeli war, answers seemed strong on this overall, with very few left blank. Most candidates were able to gain Level 2 or Level 3. The best candidates were able to explain two reasons for importance with a good range of specifics and well-developed analysis. The most common explanations were the Arab Israeli war helping Israel establish itself as a state, the development of the IDF and the Law of Return. It was very common for candidates to mistake the land gains in this war for the land gains in the Six Day war. Many answers made reference to "350%' land gain and "Sinai, Gaza, West Bank and Golan Heights' in an attempt to evidence Israeli territory gain. There were still a handful of candidates who treated this question like a narrative account, giving a very descriptive answer focus. Some candidates often showed very detailed knowledge but only considered the importance implicitly, preventing them from getting top marks despite impressive knowledge.

In terms of the question on Henry Kissinger, the most successful responses showed good knowledge of shuttle diplomacy, the reopening of the Suez Canal and the impact of future negotiations. Most candidates identified shuttle diplomacy or something along these lines and most were able to paint a picture of Kissinger's role in kick-starting peace negotiations and preparing the groundwork for peace. Unfortunately, a large number of candidates seemed to think that Kissinger was directly involved in Camp David and another (not insignificant number) thought he was even involved in the Oslo Peace process. Quite a few candidates were able to identify Sadat and Begin as key players but detail was lacking in terms of dates or key points of strategy. Few provided dates and a worrying minority seemed to think that Kissinger was US president.

In terms of the question on the First Palestinian Intifada the most common responses identified the importance for generating Palestinian unity, for generating public awareness in the rest of the world and for media attention. The most common detail was to identify the IDF breaking bones of stone throwers. A minority of strong responses focused on the Intifada being a key determiner of Oslo. Other strong answers knew about and could explain the relevance of UNLU and Arafat renouncing terrorism. It was disappointing that wider aspects of the Intifada and the different forms it took were often

absent. A small minority of candidates mistook the Intifada for Palestinian resistance in the 1960s or 70s and some were not able to explain what the Intifada was at all.

Indicate your FIRST choice on this page.

Indicate which question you are answering by marking a cross in the box ☒. If you change your mind, put a line through the box ☒ and then indicate your new question with a cross ☒.

- ☐ The importance of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49) for the state of Israel.
- ☒ The importance of Henry Kissinger for diplomatic relations between Israel and Egypt.
- ☐ The importance of the First Palestinian Intifada (1987–93) for the Palestinian issue.

Henry Kissenger ~~played~~ and his shuttle diplomacy played a very crucial role in ~~strengthening~~ encouraging good relations between Israel and Egypt. ~~In 1974, he~~ After the Yom Kippur War Kissinger was tasked to attempt to create peace between Israel, Syria and Egypt. While he failed at creating peace he was successful in ~~a~~ causing both Israel and Egypt to agree ~~to not f~~ that when they had an issue, they would sort it out through talking and negotiations ~~and~~ rather then war. This was ~~crucial~~ significant because ~~it to~~ this ~~it~~ meant that Israel and Egypt were effectively no longer at war and it also had the effect of causing both ~~leader~~ to be more ~~faithful~~ optimistic ~~encouraging~~ towards peace talks, improving diplomatic relations

Kissinger's Shuttle diplomacy also ~~encourage~~ caused Israeli and Egyptian troops to withdraw away from the Suez Canal. this allowed the Suez Canal to be opened shortly after ~~in 1975~~ in 1975, ~~Egypt's~~ strengthening diplomatic relations between the countries ~~as they both were able to benefit ff~~ because since Israel allowed Egypt to reopen the canal, Egypt listed the ban and Israel was allowed to use it.

Indicate your SECOND choice on this page.

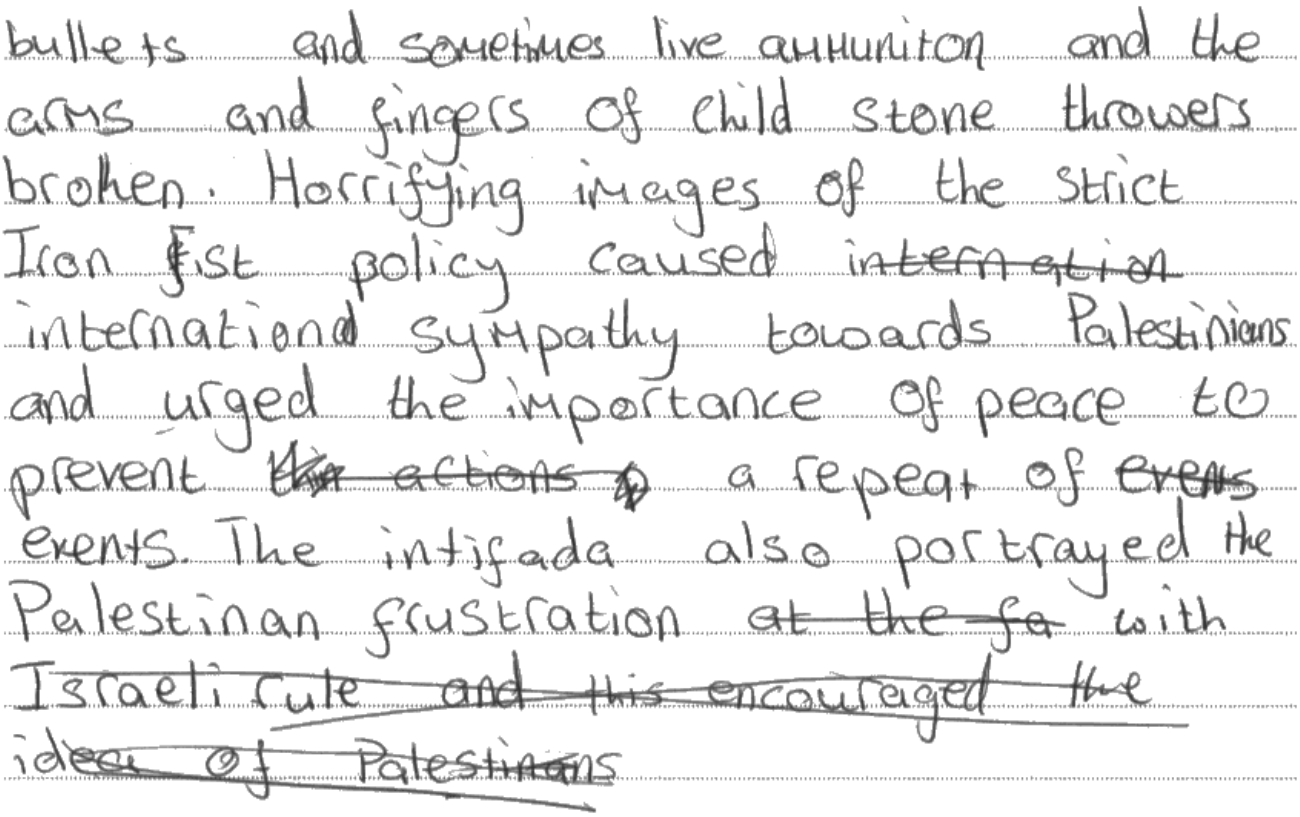
Indicate which question you are answering by marking a cross in the box ☒. If you change your mind, put a line through the box ☒ and then indicate your new question with a cross ☒.

- ~~☒~~ The importance of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49) for the state of Israel.
- ☐ The importance of Henry Kissinger for diplomatic relations between Israel and Egypt.
- ☒ The importance of the First Palestinian Intifada (1987–93) for the Palestinian issue.

~~The First Palestinian Intifada was important for the Palestinian cause because it was able to put the Palestinian cause displayed the importance of a~~ issue

~~pe~~ need

The First Palestinian Intifada was important for the Palestian issue because it ~~&~~ emphasised the need for a Palestinan - Israeli peace treaty. Palestinans had been infuriated by the way they had been treated and ~~when a Palestinan was killed by an Israeli in 1987~~ after a series of Palestian deaths, riots ~~emerged~~ throughout the West Bank and Gaza. To combat this, Israeli Prime Minister Shamir enforced ~~the~~ The Iron Fist policy. ~~When~~ This included strict Military curfews and searches on Palestians, crowds being dispersed by IDF soliders with tear gas, ~~and~~ rubber



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Examiner Comments

First: Kissinger - This candidate had provided an explanation, showing analysis, with a line of reasoning. This is done succinctly and maintains a line of reasoning, making the AO2 Level 3. It is supported with accurate and relevant knowledge, with reference to the shuttle diplomacy, opening of Suez, making the AO1 Level 3. Hence the best fit is the top of Level 3.
Second: Intifada - This candidate has an explanation, with analysis of importance, regarding reaction and yet the line of reasoning is not fully maintained, making the AO2 a weak Level 3. The knowledge used for support is relevant and accurate, such as the Iron Fist policy and its impact, making the AO1 a Level 3. Hence the best fit is middle of Level 3.

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Examiner Tip

Candidates need to provide specific knowledge to support their explanation.

Indicate your FIRST choice on page.

Indicate which question you are answering by marking a cross in the box ☒. If you change your mind, put a line through the box ☒ and then indicate your new question with a cross ☒.

- ☒ The importance of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49) for the state of Israel.
- ☒ The importance of Henry Kissinger for diplomatic relations between Israel and Egypt.
- ☒ The importance of the First Palestinian Intifada (1987–93) for the Palestinian issue.

One main importance of the Arab-Israeli war for the state of Israel is that it showed that Arab states should not underestimate Israel simply because it was a new country ran by migrants and barely independent in its own right. The war was a showcase of Israel's tactics and their way of handling conflict which remained unwavered throughout the course of other conflicts involving Israel.

Another reason why it is important is because it ~~humiliati~~ humiliated the Arab states, which is significant because it ~~or~~ reaffirmed ~~to~~ the narrative of Israel being righteous in their own right. Considering that this was just a few years after the Holocaust, it painted the Arab States in a negative light to the rest of the world.

Indicate your SECOND choice on this page.

Indicate which question you are answering by marking a cross in the box ☒. If you change your mind, put a line through the box ☒ and then indicate your new question with a cross ☒.

- ☒ The importance of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49) for the state of Israel.
- ☒ The importance of Henry Kissinger for diplomatic relations between Israel and Egypt.
- ☒ The importance of the First Palestinian Intifada (1987–93) for the Palestinian issue.

Henry Kissinger expedited the peace talks between Israel and Egypt massively. His constant back-and-forth between Israel, Egypt and Syria, showed the attention the US had on setting things between them. His efforts resulted in the first formal sit-down between the nations in the 1974 Camp Daviel accords in the US.

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Examiner Comments

First: Arab-Israeli War - This candidate provides an explanation and attempts to analyse how Israel was viewed as result of the war, making the AO2 a Level 2. There is some understanding of the period but little specific knowledge in support, making the AO1 a weak Level 2. Hence the best fit is the middle of Level 2.
Second: Kissinger - This candidate provides an explanation and attempts to analyse Kissinger's role, but is not developed making the AO2 a weak Level 2. There is accurate knowledge of the period, such as "back and forth" and "Camp David Accords" making the AO1 a Level 2. Hence the best fit is the middle of Level 2.

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Examiner Tip

It is important that points are explained, not simply described, to demonstrate analysis of the topic. Two well-developed explanations that also have good knowledge and understanding will enable candidates to attain Level 3.

Paper Summary

Candidates need a third aspect of content to access Level 3 for AO1 on Question 02.

Candidates should be reminded to focus on the date range given in any question, especially on Question 02, as material outside of the time frame is mostly unrewardable and therefore wastes valuable examination time.

Centres are reminded that candidates need to ensure that to achieve Level 3 on Question 03, they should relate the importance of the named event, individual or development to the situation and/or unfolding development in the second part of the question.

Centres are also reminded that where candidates need extra space for a response, this should be on separate extra paper rather than within the space provided for a different question. Where candidates have special consideration to word process their responses, centres should ensure that their B (British Depth Study) and P (Period Study) responses are separated from each other.

Grade boundaries

Grade boundaries for this, and all other papers, can be found on the website on this link:

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